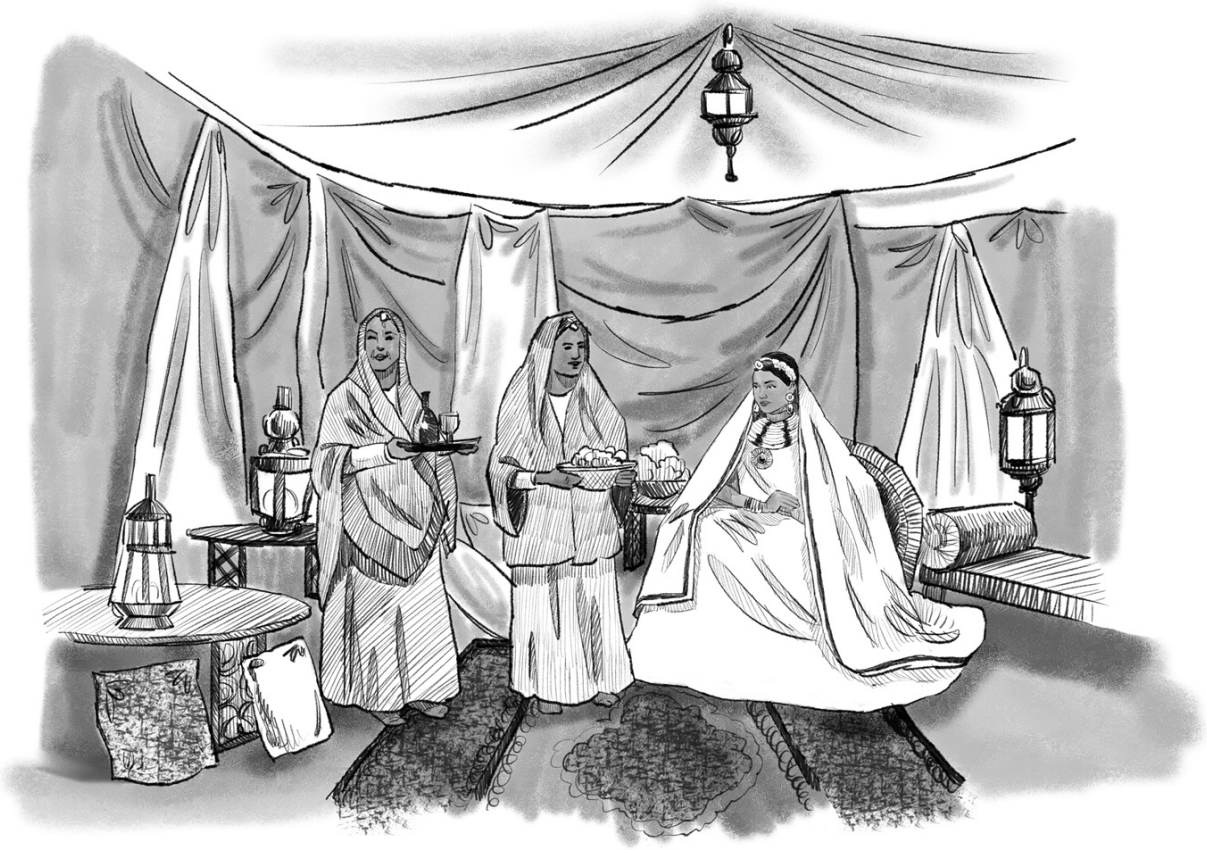


Mumtaz, however, was not roughing it. Her tent was not the kind you bring on a camping trip. It was huge and had many comforts. The royal tent was surrounded by wooden panels decorated with scarlet cloth. It had many halls, including one for Mumtaz and her attendants. In another, Khurram received visits from his officers and advisors. Chefs prepared meals in special ovens. Lamps burning a mix of cotton seed and oil lit up the night. Singers, dancers, and musicians provided entertainment. There were two of these royal tents. Early each morning, servants would ride ahead to the next stopping place. There they would set up a new tent for Khurram, Mumtaz, and the rest of the court. By the time the royal party arrived, everything was ready for them.